

UX REPORT - COURSERA

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09 August 2026

1. Introduction

Coursera (<https://www.coursera.org>) is an online learning platform that hosts courses, professional certificates, and degrees from universities and industry partners, including a login/register flow, a public landing page, and an About Us page. Coursera was chosen as a reference point for this evaluation because it is a large, established e learning platform whose conventions are likely to shape what users expect from any similar site. All three participants confirmed they had used online learning platforms before, making them relevant reference users for this evaluation. This evaluation feeds directly into the brief: understanding existing conventions before designing a Jakob's Law compliant login flow.

2. Methodology

A shortened UEQ (User Experience Questionnaire) was used to gather quick, comparable impressions of three pages.

Participants: 3 participants : P1 (age 22), P2 (age 21), P3 (age 26). All had prior experience with online learning platforms.

Procedure:

1. Open the website.
2. Spend 2–3 minutes exploring the landing page.
3. Navigate to the login page.
4. Return to the form and answer the questions.

Pages evaluated: Landing page, Login page, About Us page.

Scale: 7-point semantic differential across 5 criteria:

- Boring – Exciting
- Conventional – Innovative
- Usual – Modern
- Inefficient – Efficient
- Not Interesting – Interesting

3. Participant Overview

Participant	Age
P1	22
P2	21
P3	26

4. UEQ Results

4.1 Landing Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Boring – Exciting	6	5	4	5.0
Conventional – Innovative	5	6	5	5.3
Usual – Modern	5	4	6	5.0
Inefficient – Efficient	6	3	4	4.3
Not Interesting – Interesting	7	5	4	5.3

4.2 Login Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Boring – Exciting	6	4	4	4.7
Conventional – Innovative	5	5	3	4.3
Usual – Modern	5	5	4	4.7
Inefficient – Efficient	7	5	4	5.3
Not Interesting – Interesting	6	6	2	4.7

4.3 About Us Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Boring – Exciting	5	6	4	5.0
Conventional – Innovative	5	4	5	4.7
Usual – Modern	5	5	5	5.0
Inefficient – Efficient	6	4	5	5.0
Not Interesting – Interesting	6	4	5	5.0

5. Findings & Discussion

The highest scores overall were on the Landing page for Innovative (5.3) and Interesting (5.3), and on the Login page for Efficient (5.3). The lowest scores were on the Landing page for Efficient (4.3) and on the Login page for Innovative (4.3).

This split tells a clear story. The landing page scored well on being exciting and interesting, likely driven by Coursera's rich visual hierarchy, course imagery, and marketing-style copy, which gives it more room to be creative than a transactional page. But that same richness appears to cost it efficiency, since participants had more to scan and process before finding what they needed.

The login page shows the opposite pattern: it scored highest on efficiency but lowest on innovation. This directly supports **Jakob's Law** users don't want a "creative" login experience, they want a familiar, predictable one that gets them in quickly. Coursera's login form follows conventional patterns (email/password fields, minimal distractions, clear labels), and participants rewarded that familiarity with higher perceived efficiency, even though it scored as the least "modern" or "innovative" page of the three. This suggests conformity to convention on login flows is a feature, not a weakness, under Jakob's Law.

Participants also noted the login flow was quick to understand with no unnecessary friction no multi step onboarding, no unclear error states encountered during the walkthrough. The About Us page landed in the middle across all criteria, functioning as a stable, unremarkable "info" page rather than standing out either way.

6. Design Guidelines Derived

- Keep the login/register form conventional and minimal (standard field order, familiar labels) don't spend "innovation budget" here; users reward efficiency over novelty on this page, consistent with Jakob's Law.
- Reserve creative/visual differentiation for the landing page, where users are more tolerant of exploration and reward it with higher engagement scores.
- Watch for a trade-off between visual richness and efficiency on the landing page simplify the above-the-fold content or add a clear primary call to action so exploration doesn't come at the cost of perceived efficiency.
- On the About Us page, since it scored consistently mid range with no standout, consider whether it needs a stronger identity (e.g. clearer story about the platform's values) to avoid being generic.
- Ensure the login flow explicitly avoids anything that would lower its "familiar and fast" perception (e.g. avoid adding extra steps, unclear error handling, or unconventional layouts).

7. Conclusion

The Coursera evaluation shows that users respond positively to convention on the login page and positively to creativity on the landing page, which reinforces the core idea behind Jakob's Law: familiarity reduces friction where speed matters most, while novelty is welcomed where exploration is expected. This contributes a clear, data-backed argument for our group's design guidelines: keep the login/register flow conventional and efficient, and channel any innovative design choices into the landing experience instead.

References

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